



Doyen of the sport: The 35-year-old Priyank Panchal finishes as Gujarat's second-highest run-getter in First-Class cricket, 19 short of Parthiv Patel's tally of 7011 runs. K. MURALI KUMAR

3 crore-plus a season and often do not even play a single game.

The argument that it is market forces is not really valid, for more often than not, it is sheer good fortune as some franchises want to take a punt with young talent. Have a look at the uncapped crorepatis throughout the IPL, and you will find that very few have gone on to do big things for India. It's their good luck that has made them the crores that they actually don't deserve.

Make no mistake, it is not their fault if franchises splurge on them, but then when you see somebody like Panchal spend his whole youth playing the game in all conditions as stated above, and then not even finish with half the amount that some uncapped youngster gets, it makes others also wonder whether it's worth playing in the national tournament, the Ranji Trophy.

The BCCI has increased the match fees in recent times, and that's very good, but if they add the slab system of fees whereby those who play more matches get more, then that would make more players turn up for the Ranji Trophy instead of feigning injury just a month or so before the IPL starts, so that they don't get injured and miss out on the IPL.

If the BCCI can also increase the match fees for the teams that reach the knockouts, then that also would be a great incentive for the players to keep playing further, instead of withdrawing in fear of injury before the IPL. Money is not the issue for the BCCI and its affiliated units, so hopefully, these suggestions will be considered before the new domestic season starts.

For now, congratulations to RCB and all the best to our boys as they take on England in what promises to be a tough series.



Look at Rajinder Goel and Padmakar Shivalkar. They would have been certainties in most other countries' Test teams, but with the four great spinners in Bishan Singh Bedi, Erapalli Prasanna, B. S. Chandrasekhar, and S. Venkataraghavan around, they couldn't get a look-in even once.